

Motorola Razr 50 Ultra

Flippin' cool

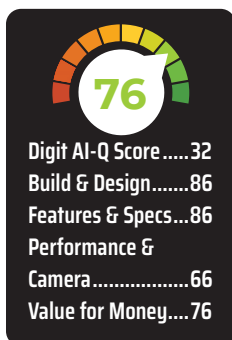
Motorola has recently launched the next generation Razr, dubbed the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra, to much fanfare. This device is marketed as more than just a foldable phone; it aims to be a powerhouse of AI capabilities. However, with the launch of the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 6 looming on the horizon, does the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra do enough to cement its position in the Flip Foldable segment firmly?

BUILD AND DESIGN

Priced at ₹99,999, the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra plays in the big leagues right alongside the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 5 and the OPPO Find N3 Flip. Motorola has ensured that the unboxing experience stands out, by not just including niceties like a colour-matched case but also the Moto Buds+ TWS earbuds that cost ₹9,999. While the inclusion of the Moto Buds+ may seem like a bonus, the inability to opt out of this to save some bucks could slight some people. Still, I'm not going to complain much since we are living in an age where some retail boxes omit chargers.

Design-wise, the Razr 50 Ultra features Gorilla Glass Victus on the cover display, a leather back, and an aluminium frame. It looks sleek and premium; worth every rupee you have paid for it. The phone measures 7.09 mm thick when unfolded and 15.32 mm when folded, weighing a manageable 188g. It's not the slimmest foldable on the market, but its curved contours and light weight ensure it doesn't feel unnecessarily bulky.

The crease on the foldable display is nearly invisible, which is a HUGE bonus. Motorola has revamped its hinge technology once again to reduce the visibility of the crease further, so props to the company there. The Razr 50 Ultra is IPX8 certified, making it water-resistant, but it



lacks dust resistance, which is a notable omission for a premium device. Motorola claims to have integrated a new cover design and brush filters to minimise dust damage though. The in-hand feel of the device is excellent, with the premium soft-touch leather providing a grippy texture.

However, the tall 22:9 aspect ratio of the main screen makes it challenging to reach the top of the display with one hand. Additionally, some apps do not display correctly on the cover screen, and orientation can get messed up when switching from the cover screen to the main display. These bugs should hopefully get fixed via future OTA updates.

All minor niggles aside, the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra is a masterclass in foldable design. OEMs should take a page out of Motorola's book to know how to do a cover screen right.

DISPLAY(S)

The Razr 50 Ultra features a massive 4-inch cover screen and a 6.9-inch inner display, both using LTPO pOLED technology with HDR10+ and Dolby Vision

certification. You also get 165 Hz refresh rate support on both displays, making these some of the most kitted-out displays on a Flip phone. However, as of now, HDR doesn't work on Netflix; only on YouTube, which is disappointing. And 165 Hz refresh rate only activates in certain games.

These displays offer vibrant colours and excellent brightness levels, making for a pretty impressive visual experience. I measured a maximum brightness of 1,375 nits on the main display and 1,116 nits on the cover display on Auto-Brightness Mode, which is pretty good.

The cover screen, in particular, is a standout feature, allowing users to run almost any app, a functionality unheard of among current flip phones on the market. This versatility transforms the cover screen from a simple notification display to a genuinely useful secondary screen.

Texting on the cover screen is surprisingly easy, thanks to its large size and responsive touch capabilities. Even gaming is feasible on the cover screen; playing Pokémon Unite, for instance, was a surprisingly smooth experience.

PERFORMANCE

The Motorola Razr 50 Ultra runs on Android 14 with Motorola's HelloUI, providing nearly flagship specifications with a Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 processor, LPDDR5X RAM, and UFS 4.0 storage. With 12GB of RAM and 512GB of internal storage, the device offers ample space and RAM. However, the presence of a USB 2.0 port is a letdown, especially at this price point, where a USB 3.2 port would have been more appropriate.

Despite the high-end specifications, the performance of the Razr 50 Ultra is somewhat disappointing. The Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 processor, paired with 12GB of RAM and UFS 4.0 storage, should theoretically provide close to top-tier performance. However, in practice, the device falls short. In CPU benchmarks, the Razr 50 Ultra scored lower than the Moto Razr 40 Ultra in some tests, which is equipped with the Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1. This performance gap is unexpected and concerning for a device marketed as a flagship. The Razr 50 Ultra also suffers